

3.1.6 Area of study 5: Jazz

For the purpose of this specification, jazz is defined as a style of music characterised by a strong but flexible rhythmic understructure with solo and ensemble improvisations on basic tunes and chord patterns and a highly sophisticated harmonic idiom from 1920 to the present.

Named artists

- Louis Armstrong
- Duke Ellington
- Charlie Parker
- Miles Davis

- Pat Metheny
- Gwilym Simcock

Musical elements

The following table contains all the musical elements, for this area of study, that students must know and understand to answer questions in section A (Listening) and section C (Essay) of the exam. Marks will also be awarded for knowledge of other terms, if relevant to this area of study, in section C (Essay) of the exam.

Element type	Element
Melody	• glissando • pitch-bend • smear • spill/fall-off • rip.
Harmony	• chord extension – secondary 7th, 9th, 11th, 13th chords • other added notes – eg 2nd, 6th, sus4th • substitution (especially tritone substitution) • commonly used jazz harmony symbols • turn-around.
Tonality	• blue notes • blues scale • pentatonic scale • diminished (octatonic) scale • knowledge of specific modes for modal jazz.
Structure	• 12-bar blues • chord changes • song form/standard form • middle eight/bridge • intro and outro • head • chorus • fours • break.
Sonority (Timbre)	• growl/talking trumpet • harmon mute • wah-wah mute • ghosted notes • slap bass • rim-shot • standard big band instruments.

Element type	Element
Texture	• heterophonic • a cappella
Tempo, metre and rhythm	• swing and straight rhythm • cross rhythms eg three over four • push and drag • double time • ametrical • stop time • riff.